

How to Use This Guide

This guide tells you exactly how to watch every World Cup 2026 match — free, legally, from anywhere. We cover the broadcaster for every country, the best free streaming apps, and exactly how to set up a VPN to access any country's free stream from anywhere in the world.

WC2026 EMPIRE

Part 1: Free Streams by Country

■■ United States

Most matches are free on Fox over-the-air. For matches on FS1/FS2, you need cable or a streaming service.

- Fox Sports (Fox / FS1 / FS2) — Available free with cable or antenna
- Peacock — Some matches exclusively on Peacock (NBC streaming service)
- Telemundo / Peacock en Español — Full coverage in Spanish, free
- FuboTV — Streaming service with Fox Sports included (free trial available)
- Sling TV — Fox channels included, cheapest paid streaming option
- YouTube TV — Full Fox Sports access, free trial available

WC2026 Streaming Bible

How to watch every match free in any country

■■ United Kingdom

The UK has the best World Cup deal on earth. Every match, free, on BBC or ITV. No VPN, no subscription.

- BBC One / BBC iPlayer — Free with TV licence. Up to 33 matches available
- ITV / ITVX — Free. Remaining matches split between BBC and ITV
- Every single World Cup 2026 match broadcast free on BBC or ITV
- No VPN needed — the best deal in world football broadcasting
- BBC iPlayer: watch on any device, replay available for 30 days

\$7.99

■■ Canada

Most matches available free on CTV. Check TSN for remaining games.

- CTV — Free over-the-air, free streaming on CTV.ca
- TSN / RDS (French) — Cable channels, may require subscription
- Sportsnet — Some matches on Sportsnet (Rogers)
- DAZN Canada — May have rights to certain matches

■■ Australia

Australia has an outstanding deal. SBS has shown every World Cup for decades, always free.

- SBS On Demand — Completely FREE, every match, no subscription
- SBS app: available on iOS, Android, Smart TV, Chromecast, Apple TV

- Optus Sport — Backup option if SBS doesn't carry all games
- Watch on any device — SBS requires free account creation only

■ ■ Germany

ARD and ZDF broadcast the majority of matches for free. MagentaTV may have some exclusives.

- ARD (Das Erste) — Free national broadcaster, no subscription
- ZDF — Free national broadcaster. ARD and ZDF split all matches
- ARD Mediathek / ZDF Mediathek — Free streaming apps
- MagentaTV — Some matches exclusively on MagentaTV (Deutsche Telekom)

■ ■ France

Most major matches on TF1 or M6 for free.

- TF1 — Free national broadcaster, major matches
- M6 — Free, remaining matches
- TF1+ / 6play — Free streaming apps for replays
- beIN Sports — Some exclusive matches (subscription required)

■ ■ Brazil

Globo has the dominant rights in Brazil. Most matches free on Globo TV.

- Globo — Free broadcast, majority of matches
- SporTV — Pay TV channel (Globosat), cable required
- CazéTV (YouTube) — May stream select matches free
- Prime Video Brazil — May have streaming rights

■ ■ Spain

All matches covered free between RTVE and Mediaset.

- RTVE (La 1) — Free national broadcaster
- Mediaset España (Telecinco/Cuatro) — Free, shares rights with RTVE
- RTVE Play — Free streaming app, replays available

■ ■ Italy

RAI covers most matches free in Italy.

- RAI (Rai 1/Rai 2) — Free national broadcaster
- RaiPlay — Free streaming app
- Mediaset (Canale 5) — Some matches on free-to-air Mediaset

■ ■ Netherlands

NOS and RTL split the rights; most matches free.

- NOS — Free national broadcaster
- RTL 4 — Free commercial channel
- NOS.nl / NPO Start — Free streaming

Part 2: VPN Guide — Watch Any Country's Free Stream

A VPN (Virtual Private Network) lets you appear to be in any country. This means you can access the UK's BBC iPlayer, Australia's SBS, or Germany's ARD from anywhere in the world — completely free. Here's exactly how.

Step-by-Step: Set Up NordVPN (Recommended)

- 1. Go to nordvpn.com (or use the link at wc2026-empire.vercel.app/watch/) and sign up. Plans start from £2.99/month.
- 2. Download the NordVPN app for your device: iOS, Android, Windows, Mac, Smart TV, or browser extension.
- 3. Open the app and log in with your new account.
- 4. Click the map or search for the country whose stream you want to access. Example: click 'United Kingdom' to access BBC iPlayer.
- 5. Click 'Connect'. Your internet now appears to be in that country.
- 6. Open your browser and go to bbc.co.uk/iplayer (or any free stream for that country).
- 7. Watch freely. No buffering — NordVPN uses high-speed streaming servers.
- 8. When the match is over, click 'Disconnect' to return to your real location.

Best Countries to Connect To for Free Streams

Country to Connect	Free Stream Available	Best For
■ United Kingdom	BBC iPlayer / ITV	Every match — best free deal globally
■ Australia	SBS On Demand	All matches, very reliable, English
■ Germany	ARD Mediathek / ZDF	High-quality stream, all major matches
■ France	TF1+ / 6play	All major matches, French commentary
■ Spain	RTVE Play	All matches, Spanish commentary
■ Italy	RaiPlay	Most matches, Italian commentary

Part 3: Best Apps by Device

■ iPhone / iPad

- BBC iPlayer (App Store — free)
- ITVX (App Store — free)
- SBS On Demand (App Store — free)
- NordVPN (App Store — needed for geo-unblocking)

■ Android

- BBC iPlayer (Play Store — free)
- ITVX (Play Store — free)
- SBS On Demand (Play Store — free)
- NordVPN (Play Store)

■ Smart TV (Samsung/LG)

- Install BBC iPlayer app from TV's app store
- Many NordVPN-compatible routers can protect whole TV
- Alternatively: cast from phone using VPN

■ Amazon Firestick

- Download BBC iPlayer from Fire TV store
- Install NordVPN from Fire TV store
- Connect to UK server → open BBC iPlayer → done

■ Apple TV

- BBC iPlayer available in App Store
- ExpressVPN has native Apple TV app (easier setup)

■ Desktop/Laptop

- BBC iPlayer: bbc.co.uk/iplayer
- Install NordVPN browser extension for Chrome/Firefox
- Or install NordVPN desktop app (faster)